disputes erupted and escalated. Second, we maintain that the possible deployment of missile defense in South Asia, far from stabilizing the subcontinent, is likely to create incentives for aggressive regional behavior. And finally, we argue that nuclear weapons are unlikely to resolve the central security threat currently facing South Asia: Islamist militants not fully under the control of any government. Instead of relying on nuclear deterrence, India and Pakistan should thoroughly rethink their approaches to national security, adopting policies far outside their traditional comfort zones.